Centennial School Council Meeting —- Minutes—
Feb 23, 2022

Attendees: Heidi Holmes (part of meeting), Harish Pawagi, Courtney Uniac, Julie Turner, Laura Cowley

Student Report: no student present for report

Vice-Principal's report:

- Provided overview of meeting between Heidi and Steve and Julie week prior with focus on how to engage members of marginalized communities in the school and School Council. Had agreed to focus on Muslim population as they make up a large part of our school. Reviewed some activities and engagement already being done within the school. Also plan to reach out to local Imam for their perspective and as a potential person of importance in the community who may be able to help us engage others. Also agreed to host a school open house in the spring in which School Council will also present and share "who we are" and "why you should become involved" with the larger school community including those of the Muslim faith. Heidi also shared about the WRDSB Listening Forums being offered for various marginalized groups, including the Muslim community within the WRDSB and if ok, she will attend to hear the perspectives and hopefully be able to bring back to this group how we can be more aware of barriers and possible ways to engage in a more productive manner. Harish also mentioned presenter available through BEP re: growing up in two cultures; **Julie/Heidi/Harish will follow up to see if available and appropriate for a parent engagement forum and/or Spring Open House once planned.** Discussion around barriers and accommodations, including language, being present as a visible minority, and creating new space where everyone belongs versus trying to fit people into the existing space.
- Sports and Clubs can resume as of recently. Centennial is looking at how we will do this. Can mix cohorts; must track attendance; identify staff who can take part and lead. Cohorting at outdoor breaks is still in place for now.
- Staff meetings continue to focus on how to continue to work on dismantling inherent racism within systems

Teacher's Report:

- Unlearn murals designed to be thought provoking/ask questions and push back against previous learning. School budgeted for 4 murals and School Council provided funds for 2 additional murals. Posters (6) are now up in the school. Nima shared pictures from in school of murals along with adjoining question/prompt plaques. Class 5 will lead Ambassador led discussions with Core Teachers in classes. Total cost of posters were discussed; portion from School Council was $1276.90 incl tax.; had planned for $1300 which included measuring fee. Harish will deduct this from our budget. Suggestion that

we provide communication to school community/parents about the murals, contributions, outcomes, etc. This may help address gap in communication/connection between school and community. **Julie will follow up with Steve to post something on School Day**

Treasurer role will be filled by Harish Pawagi:

- $23945.00 in school funds.
- 2 planned withdrawals: $15,000 for sound system and $1300.00 for murals
- Will have $7645 available
- Plan to have $3000 reserve
- Need budget to plan for spending $4645; see agenda item re: fundraising and spending

WRAPSC update: deferred; Heidi to send summary via email

Fundraising:

- Suggestions for funds included: teacher wish list,; Gr 8 Grad (Mrs. Turner explained why this won't happen)
- Fundraising ideas include: chocolate bars, Mabels Labels, Magazines, pizza, Spirit Wear, popcorn
- Centennial has historically provided 10% of funds raised to a school in need

Discussion around Gr 8 Grad from Julie: not a graduation; it is a celebration. No awards. No money spent all in name of equity. Hope to have an in person walk through to honour Gr 8s; will await PH and WRDSB guidelines.

Julie and Steve will discuss what goals of fundraising will be and bring to Council in March.

Laura will create Google Doc to share fundraising ideas

Equity Discussion: Want to engage more people, especially from marginalized communities in School Council and events. Nima is willing to help out. Discussion re: in person vs online pros and cons. Currently send agenda and minutes via School Day and on school website; Have meetings online. Need to clarify goal and purpose and let people know what is in it for them. Some short term suggestions would be to: provide day of reminder with link, provide benefits of attendance, clarify what we are looking for from others, reminders that we want to see new faces and they can join anytime. Also **Steve/Julie/council** plan to have goal of survey of key stakeholders of certain communities fand surveying their perspectives and needs. Also apathy is an issue. Agreed to continue to discuss.
Review of Meeting with Equity Lens: being able to see everyone on screen is helpful. Everyone felt they could contribute (except for technical issues). Looking for raised hands and allowing time for voices to be heard has helped. All of this is easy with smaller group. Asking for agenda items.

Next meeting – March 23rd; send items to Heidi or Laura